Introduction to the Course

ECON 201: Principles of Microeconomics
Lecture 1

Div Bhagia

Today

- Who am I and why am I here?
- Who are you and why are you here?
- What is this class about and will it be fun?
- How to succeed in this class?
- A short intro diagnostic (ungraded, obviously)

About me







Delhi → Boston → SoCal

About you

Go to menti.com

Code: **9617 8896**

Or scan the code. Answers are anonymous.



What is this class about?

- Economics is about choices when you cannot have everything
- Microeconomics: the choices of people and firms, and the markets where they meet
- Macroeconomics, for contrast: the whole economy at once
- We build a small set of tools, then point them at real questions

Questions we will answer

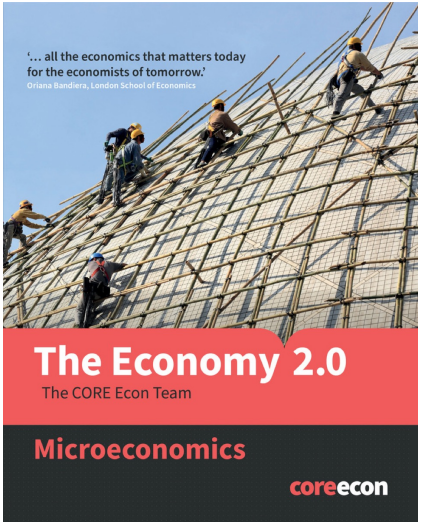
- Why do ten companies own most grocery brands?
- Why does Cheerios cost more than the store brand next to it?
- When egg prices spiked, was that greed or cost?
- Who really pays a gas tax, the oil company or you?
- Do rent caps make housing affordable?
- Why is there more pollution than anyone wants?

Textbook

The Economy 2.0: Microeconomics, CORE Econ

- Free to read online
- Sections listed in the schedule

books.core-econ.org



What your grade is made of

Writing assignment, Part 1	5
Writing assignment, Part 2	10
Quizzes (8 in class, lowest 2 dropped)	30
Midterm 1	15
Midterm 2	15
Final exam (cumulative)	25
Total	**100**

Three things I ask of you

- **Be here.** Attend class.
- **Be present.** Phones and laptops away; tablets flat for notes okay.
- **Take part.** Participate by completing worksheets, answering questions, and asking questions.

How to succeed

- Keep up with the reading as it is assigned
- Do each week's practice problems before looking at the solutions
- Go over the slides and the worksheets we do in class each week (everything is on the course website)
- When in doubt, ask questions in class or office hours
- If feasible, work with other classmates

What's next?

- Today: a short diagnostic quiz
- Before Wednesday: read the syllabus and the course website, and bring questions
- Wednesday: How did we end up in a world more prosperous than any before it?